



1-10-2023 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PGL1WKt73NI
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Target Category	mcs

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting: Muncie Community Schools Board of School Trustees

Date: January 11, 2023 (*Implicit from New Year holiday references, MLK Day mentions, and December 2022 financial results*)

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(Omitted: The transcript does not contain a statutory public hearing or committee work session held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the meeting to order, welcomed attendees, and wished everyone a Happy New Year before leading a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance [00:02:17](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Dr. O'Neill, Mr. Heater, Dr. Bales, Mrs. Watasha Barnes Griffin, Mr. Mark Urban, and Mr. Jim Lowe.
 - **Members Absent:** None (Roll call confirmed all members present).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Board President explicitly identified through spoken cues (referred to as President Williams).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opening moment of silence and Pledge of Allegiance led by the presiding officer 00:02:21.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Handled under the consent agenda (Items 5.01 through 5.05), approved by voice vote 01:05:01.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:08 Volunteer & Community Engagement Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Allison Quirk (Volunteer/Community Engagement Coordinator).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Quirk presented a 6-month update detailing community partnerships, including the “DEAR” (Drop Everything and Read) program with Ball State volunteers at Southview, 150 winter coats donated by the Knights of Columbus, a Central High Fall Festival book giveaway, United Way campaign growth, employee walking challenges, and the launch of a Student Assistance Fund via the Community Engagement Council (CEC). Upcoming initiatives include a staff wellness fair, school business partnerships, and dual-language door hangers for attendance outreach.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no formal board action required.
- **00:26:47 Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rhonda (Diversity/Equity Director).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Provided updates on the Minority Educators Council (Mech) mixer, high school student participation in a viewing and debriefing of the movie *Till*, a hygiene product challenge organized by “Diverse Cats” students supporting local pantries, holiday card deliveries for special education students, and preparations for upcoming MLK Day citizenship awards and Black History Month events.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no formal board action required.
- **00:41:31 District Security Update & Security Proposal**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Robert Scafe (Legacy Life Security Solutions).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Scafe outlined plans to step up security protocols across all nine schools, including the implementation of periodic, random security checks at middle and high schools using handheld metal detectors (wands provided via state initiative) at main entrances, backpack spot-checks, and random K-9 locker searches (drug and bomb-sniffing dogs) conducted in partnership with local law

enforcement. Board members emphasized the importance of communicating this proactively to parents and students as a deterrent rather than a reactive measure.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [05:58:59](#). Motion passed to approve the security proposal, delegating implementation and frequency to administration and leadership in consultation with Legacy.
 - **[01:05:27](#) December 2022 Financial Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome (Chief Financial Officer).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Jerome presented the 12-month actual financial results for 2022. Highlights included \$42.4M in State Basic Grant revenue, a total checkbook cash balance of \$39.3M (growing by \$3.4M), an Education Fund balance of \$15.1M, a reduction of the state loan balance to \$10.5M, and a Rainy Day fund balance of nearly \$13.4M. Operations fund spending was kept within appropriations (\$12.6M), though 2023 will bring tighter constraints (\$10.2M limit) and \$12M in long-term debt balloon payments due to expiring 2014 GO bonds.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:15:23](#).
 - **[01:11:38](#) Property, Casualty, Workers' Comp, and Cyber Insurance Renewal**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome (CFO) / USI Insurance Agency.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented the annual insurance renewals. Overall premiums increased by approximately \$60,000 (reversing the previous year's decrease), primarily driven by a \$30,000 increase in workers' comp (affected by a loss mod of 1.8 due to slip-and-fall claims) and increased property valuation limits due to inflation.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:15:23](#).
 - **[01:15:30](#) Education-to-Operations Fund Transfer Resolution**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome (CFO).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Routine request for authorization to transfer no more than 15% of total revenue from the Education Fund to the Operations Fund for calendar year 2023, consistent with prior years.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:16:00](#).
 - **[01:16:07](#) Curriculum Adoption: English Learners (EL) Resources**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds / Kelsey Pavelka (Director of English Learners).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Recommended the adoption of Amplify K-5 Literacy resources built on the science of reading for English Language Learners. The expense is fully covered by an external grant secured by Pavelka.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:19:12](#).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- No open public comment period or citizen speakers participated during this portion of the meeting.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Employee Wellness Fair scheduled for the following day (Thursday, 3:30 PM <U+2013> 5:30 PM).
 - Upcoming Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. breakfast events and senior recognitions.
 - Administrative instructional "Process Checks" to meet with building teachers.
 - Administrative office staff volunteering one hour a week to assist third-grade students with I-READ 3 preparation.
 - **Board of Finance Interlude (01:19:21 <U+2013> 01:26:32):** The board temporarily recessed the regular meeting to convene the annual Board of Finance. Mr. Heater was elected President and Mr. Urban was elected Secretary. CFO Brad Jerome reported over \$312,000 earned in annual bank interest due to rising interest rates. The Board of Finance meeting was subsequently adjourned, and the regular school board meeting reconvened.
 - Construction fencing for upcoming capital projects going up around the football field/drive area.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially closed with a motion to adjourn, approved by voice vote 01:29:00.
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